Fred and Norah Urquhart



Born in 1911, Fred Urquhart grew up near a railroad line on the edge of Toronto, Canada, and became intrigued by the monarch butterflies that laid their eggs close to the track. After graduating in 1937 from the University of Toronto with bachelor's and master's degrees in biology, Urquhart began to research the butterfly. Having taught meteorology to pilots during World War II, he returned to the university to lecture zoology and married Norah Roden Patterson, another Toronto graduate, who joined his quest to find the monarch's winter home. Fred Urquhart also worked as Curator of Insects and Director of Zoology and Paleontology at the Royal Ontario Museum. In 1998, Fred and Norah Urquhart were awarded their nation's highest civilian award, the Order of Canada.

Key works

1960 *The Monarch Butterfly*

1987 *The Monarch Butterfly: International Traveler*

Citizens march on

More volunteer-based projects were launched during the 1960s and 1970s, including the North American Breeding Bird Survey, the British Nest Records Card project, and a survey of sea turtle egg laying in Japan. In 1979, the Royal Society for the Protection of Birds (RSPB) launched the Big Garden Birdwatch in the UK, which did not even require people to leave their own homes, but simply to record what they saw in their gardens,